

THE LEGENDRE EQUATION

The Legendre equation is given by

$$(1-x^2)y''$$

$$(1-x^2) \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n x^{n-2} - 2x \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} n a_n x^{n-1} + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \lambda(\lambda+1)a_n x^n$$

$$\sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n x^{n-2} - \sum_{n=2}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n x^n - \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} 2n a_n x^n + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \lambda(\lambda+1)a_n x^n$$

Shifting of sigma notation.

$$\sum_{n=0}^{\infty} (n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} x^n - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} n(n-1)a_n x^n - \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} 2n a_n x^n + \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \lambda(\lambda+1)a_n x^n$$

$$(n+2)(n+1)a_{n+2} - n(n-1)a_n - 2n a_n + \lambda(\lambda+1)a_n = 0$$

$$a_{n+2} = \frac{[n(n-1) + 2n - \lambda(\lambda+1)]a_n}{(n+2)(n+1)}$$

$$a_2 = \frac{-\lambda(\lambda+1)a_0}{2}$$

$$a_5 = \frac{60 - 12(\lambda+1)}{120}$$

When $n=1$

$$a_3 = \frac{2 - \lambda(\lambda+1)a_1}{6}$$

$n=2$

$$a_4 = \frac{6 - \lambda(\lambda+1)a_2}{12}$$

$$a_4 = \frac{[6 - \lambda(\lambda+1)][\lambda(\lambda+1)a_0]}{24}$$

From Power Series

$$y(x) = a_0x^0 + a_1x^1 + a_2x^2 + a_3x^3 + a_4x^4 + \dots + a_nx^n$$

$$y(x) = a_0 + a_1x + \frac{-\lambda(\lambda+1)a_0x^2}{2} + \frac{2 - \lambda(\lambda+1)a_1x^3}{6}$$

$$y(x) = a_0 \left[1 - \frac{\lambda(\lambda+1)x^2}{2} + (\lambda(\lambda+1) - 6)\lambda(\lambda+1)x^4 \right] +$$

$$a_1 \left[x + \frac{2 - \lambda(\lambda+1)x^3}{6} + \frac{72 - 12(\lambda+1) + \lambda(\lambda+1)^2x^5}{120} \right]$$

To find a polynomial LDE

$$\text{let } y=1, x=1 \quad n=\lambda$$

$P(x)$ for $n=2$

$$y(x) = a_0 \left[1 - \frac{\lambda(\lambda+1)x^2}{2} \right]$$

$$1 = a_0 [1 - 3x^2] \text{ but } x=1$$

$$1 = a_0 (-2)$$

$$a_0 = -\frac{1}{2}$$

$$P_2(x) = \frac{1}{2}(3x^2 - 1)$$

$$= \frac{1}{8}(4x^3 - 4x)$$

$$= \frac{1}{8}(12x^2 - 4)$$

$$= \frac{4}{8}(3x^2 - 1)$$

$$= \frac{1}{2}(3x^2 - 1)$$

THE RODRIGUES FORMULA

The Rodrigues formula is given by

$$P_n(x) = \frac{1}{2^n n!} \frac{d^n}{dx^n} (x^2 - 1)^n$$

For example: Find $P_2(x)$

$$P_2(x) = \frac{1}{(2^2)(2!)} \frac{d^2}{dx^2} (x^2 - 1)^2$$

$$= \frac{1}{8} \frac{d^2}{dx^2} (x^4 - 2x^2 + 1)$$

THE BESSEL'S EQUATION

The Method of Frobenius is used in finding the solution of Bessel's equation.

Example: $x^2 y_2 + x y_1 + (x^2 - \nu^2) y = 0$

To find the order of Bessel Differential Equation.

$$x^2 - \nu^2 = 0$$

$$x^2 = \nu^2$$

$$x = \pm \nu$$

∴ The B.D.E is of order ν

Example 2: Determine the order of the following B.D.E

i) $x^2 y_2 + x y_1 + (x^2 - 1/4) y = 0$

ii) $x^2 y_2 + x y_1 + (x^2 - 1) y = 0$

iii) $x y_2 - 2 y_1 + x y = 0$